IGP Readings: Key Concepts Beyond the Slides

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Only concepts from the readings that are NOT already in the class slides. Use the slides as the primary reference.

Class 1: Personality and Values (Robbins, Judge & Vohra)

- **Definition (Allport):** personality is the sum total of ways an individual reacts to and interacts with others.
- **Measuring it:** self-reports can be faked. In hiring, people rate themselves about 0.5 SD more conscientious and stable. **Observer ratings predict job success better**, and both together are best.
- **Heredity:** twin studies show genetics explains about 50% of personality similarity. People change with age, but their **rank order stays stable**. Personality is more changeable in adolescence than in adulthood.
- **MBTI:** 4 pairs (E/I, S/N, T/F, J/P) give 16 types. Most used, but **weak validity**: it forces either/or types and is unrelated to job performance. Use it for self-awareness, **not for selection**.
- **Big Five extras:** conscientiousness is the best predictor of job performance, but there is "too much of a good thing": such people adapt less well, are less creative, and learn complex skills more slowly. Emotional stability is most linked to life and job satisfaction. Extraversion predicts leadership emergence, but extraverts are more impulsive and absent more. Open people cope better with change. Agreeable people are better liked and do more citizenship behaviour, but **earn less**.
- **Dark Triad** (socially undesirable traits):
  - **Machiavellianism**: pragmatic, emotionally distant, ends justify means. Wins short term, loses long term because disliked.
  - **Narcissism**: grandiose, needs admiration, entitled. More charismatic, but more counterproductive behaviour. Narcissistic CEOs make more and pricier acquisitions.
  - **Psychopathy**: no concern for others, no remorse. Linked to hard influence tactics and bullying.
- **Approach–avoidance framework:** traits seen as motivation, either attraction to positive stimuli or aversion to negative ones.
- **Other traits:**

    - **Core self-evaluation (CSE)**: belief in your own capability and worth. Leads to ambitious goals and persistence.
    - **Self-monitoring**: ability to adjust behaviour to the situation. High self-monitors get better ratings, more promotions and central positions, but show less commitment.
    - **Proactive personality**: spots opportunities, takes initiative and perseveres.
- **Personality × situation:**
    - **Situation strength theory**: personality predicts behaviour best in **weak** situations. The 4 Cs make a situation strong: Clarity, Consistency, Constraints, Consequences.
    - **Trait activation theory**: some situations activate a trait. For example, commission pay activates extraversion.
- **Entrepreneur profile:** high E, C and O; low A and N.

Class 2: How to Play to Your Strengths (Roberts et al., HBR 2005)

- **Core idea:** people *remember* criticism but *respond* to praise. Build on strengths rather than only fixing weaknesses.
- **Negativity bias:** people recall 4 negative memories for every positive one.
- **Positive Organizational Scholarship (POS):** research on positive dynamics such as resilience, trust and vitality. Example: Losada & Heaphy found that a **5:1 ratio of positive to negative comments** boosts team performance.
- **Reflected Best Self (RBS) exercise**, in 4 steps:
    1. **Identify respondents and ask for feedback**: get specific stories of you at your best from 10–20 people inside and outside work.
    2. **Recognise patterns**: find common themes across the feedback.
    3. **Compose a self-portrait**: 2–4 paragraphs of prose starting "When I am at my best, I…". This builds your "best possible self".
    4. **Redesign your job**: make small changes to how you work, who is on your team and how you spend your time.
- **Tips:** do it at a different time from the performance review. Knowing your strengths helps you manage weaknesses, for example by finding a partner to cover them ("get me a good finance partner").

Class 3: How Leaders Create and Use Networks (Ibarra & Hunter, HBR 2007)

In the move from manager to leader, the work becomes **relational, not analytical**. Most managers underuse strategic networking.

	Operational	Personal	Strategic
Purpose	Get current work done efficiently	Personal and professional development; referrals	Figure out future priorities; get stakeholder support
Location / time	Mostly internal; present	Mostly external; present and future	Internal and external; future
Who's in it	Prescribed by the task (non-discretionary)	Discretionary (associations, alumni, clubs)	Set by strategy, but discretionary
Key attribute	**Depth** (strong working ties)	**Breadth** (referral reach)	**Leverage** (inside–outside links)

- **Operational trap:** these networks answer "how do we meet assigned goals?", not **"what should we be doing?"**
- **Personal networks** are a safe space to develop and learn, but are not enough unless their ties are linked to organisational strategy.
- **Leverage:** using one part of the network to get results in another, through indirect influence and by shaping your network (hiring, placing allies). Refusing to "play politics" can cost a leader respect and support.
- **Just do it:**
  1. **Mind your mindset**: learn from a role model who networks ethically.
  2. **Work from the outside in**: use personal interests or communities of practice as a "hook" for internal ties.
  3. **Reallocate time**: delegate to free up time for networking.
  4. **Ask and you shall receive**: give and take continually, not only when in need.
  5. **Stick to it**: networking is a skill built by will, not a talent or a matter of extraversion.

Class 4: Speaking Up (three readings)

Can Your Employees Really Speak Freely? (Detert & Burris, HBR 2016). Fear and futility are already in the slides. These are the leader mistakes behind them.

- **Mistakes that feed fear:**
  - **Anonymous feedback**: it signals that speaking openly is unsafe, it triggers "who said this?" witch hunts, and the issues are hard to fix without knowing the source.
  - **General invitations** ("open door"): too passive. Employees also hold back on initiatives the boss is personally invested in.
  - **Power cues ("ambient stimuli")**: big desk, leaning back. Example: an ER doctor's patient scores rose simply because he sat down to talk to them.
- **Mistakes that feed futility:** not modelling voice yourself, being vague about what input you want (**pseudo-participation**), and giving no resources to act on ideas. At one firm, futility was cited about 2× as often as fear.
- **Fixes:**
  - Make feedback regular and casual.
  - Be transparent about the process, with timelines.
  - **Reach out**: actively asking raised speaking up 2× more than just being open.
  - Soften power cues: MBWA (management by walking around), round tables.
  - Avoid mixed messages.
  - **Be the example**: advocate for your people upward.
  - **Close the loop**: not closing it raised futility by 30%; closing it raised voice by 19%.

Make It Safe to Speak Up, Especially in Risky Times (Hadley, Mortensen & Edmondson, HBR 2023)

- **Voice vs silence asymmetry:** the benefits of speaking up go to the organisation and are uncertain and delayed. Silence gives the individual an instant, certain feeling of safety. So **don't blame people for staying silent**.
- **Audit yourself first:** "Time does not summon courage; it morphs fear of speaking truth to power into fear of speaking truth *in* power" (Petriglieri).
- **Edmondson's winning formula:**
  1. **Clarify the rationale**: why voice is needed now, linked to the business.
  2. **Issue targeted invitations**: for example, a monthly 1:1 asking "What should I know but don't?" and "How can I better support your risk-taking?"
  3. **Stamp out punishments**: bad is stronger than good, so apologise quickly if you react badly.
  4. **Stack up rewards**: thank people, and build candour into appraisals.

Cultivating Everyday Courage (Detert, HBR 2018). Most courageous acts come from respected insiders, not martyrs. **Competent courage** can be learned in 4 steps:

1. **Lay the groundwork**: build **idiosyncrasy credits** (goodwill from a record of competence and conformity), earn trust, and improve your fallback options.
2. **Choose your battles**: ask "Is this really important?" and "Is this the right time?" Use timing, attention cycles and "burning platforms".
3. **Persuade in the moment**: frame the issue in terms of the audience's priorities and values, use data, and manage emotions (yours and theirs).
4. **Follow up**: thank people and share credit; repair relationships; keep advocating; treat failure as learning.

Tip: start with small acts and build up gradually, and keep your values front and centre.

Class 5: Strategy and Tactics of Integrative Negotiation (Lewicki et al.)

- **Context to manage:** a free flow of information, understanding the other side's real needs, emphasising commonalities, and looking for solutions that meet both sides' goals. Share **priorities, not positions**.
- **Pareto efficient frontier:** the set of deals where no one can gain without the other losing. Integrative negotiation means finding deals *on* the frontier. Creating value comes first; claiming value comes at selection.
- **Traits of an integrative negotiator:** honesty and integrity, **abundance mentality** (not zero-sum), maturity, systems orientation, superior listening.

The 4 steps

1. **Identify and define the problem** in mutually acceptable, neutral terms. State it as a goal, keep it simple, depersonalise it, and separate defining the problem from searching for solutions.
2. **Surface interests and needs** by asking "why?" (the library window example: fresh air vs no draft).
    - Types of interest: **substantive, process, relationship, principles**.
    - Interests come from deep needs (Maslow), can change over time, and can be subjective.
3. **Generate alternatives.** Strategies, from least to most information needed:
    - **Logrolling**: trade across issues. Unbundle a single issue into several.
    - **Expand the pie**: add resources. **Modify the pie**: change the resource base.
    - **Nonspecific compensation**: one side gets its way and pays the other in some unrelated currency.

    - **Cost cutting**: reduce the other side's cost of agreeing.
    - **Bridging**: a new option that meets both sides' underlying interests.
    - **Superordination**: the original interests are replaced by bigger ones.
    - Compromise is **not** a win–win option.
    - Group techniques: brainstorming (don't evaluate during it, ask outsiders), surveys, electronic brainstorming.
4. **Evaluate and select.** Narrow the options; judge on **quality and acceptability** using objective standards; **agree criteria in advance**; be willing to justify preferences; watch for intangibles; use subgroups; take time out to cool off; package options (outcome, probability, timing).

- **Firm flexibility:** be firm on interests, flexible on the means of meeting them. Signal what is a "must" and where you can move.
- **7 factors that facilitate integrative negotiation:**
    1. A **common, shared or joint goal**.
    2. Faith in one's problem-solving ability.
    3. Belief in the validity of one's own position *and* the other's perspective.
    4. Motivation and commitment to work together (common fate, **presettlement settlements**, **umbrella agreements**).
    5. Trust.
    6. Clear and accurate communication.
    7. Understanding the dynamics of integrative negotiation.

Class 6: Power Play (Pfeffer, HBR 2010)

Strategies don't implement themselves. "Where you stand depends on where you sit", so logic alone won't win; you need power. Main example: Laura Esserman (UCSF breast care centre), who had lots of responsibility but no line authority.

- **Make your peace with power:** politics is seen as the "dark side", but power pays off.
    - **McClelland & Burnham**: power-motivated managers were more effective than affiliation- or achievement-motivated ones.
    - **Political Skill Inventory** scores predicted manager success.
    - **Zia Yusuf (SAP)**: success needs business knowledge (what to do) plus political skill (getting it done).
- **Why people shy away from power (3 barriers):**
    1. **Just-world hypothesis**: "good work will be rewarded".
    2. **The leadership literature**: it describes how we wish leaders behaved.

3. **Self-handicapping**: if you never try for power, not getting it isn't a personal failure.

- **Power is good for health:** Marmot's study of British civil servants found lower job control linked to higher heart-disease mortality.
- **11 ways to exercise power:**
  1. **Mete out resources**: money, information, access (Klaus Schwab at Davos). Help evokes reciprocity.
  2. **Shape behaviour through rewards and punishments**.
  3. **Advance on multiple fronts**: if one is blocked, shift to another (Lalit Modi with the BCCI and IPL).
  4. **Make the first move**: surprise opponents.
  5. **Co-opt antagonists**: give them a stake (Illinois Committee on the Status of Women).
  6. **Remove rivals, nicely if possible**: "strategic outplacement"; let them save face.
  7. **Don't draw unnecessary fire**: ask "what would victory look like?"; "live to fight another day".
  8. **Use the personal touch** (Jack Valenti).
  9. **Persist**: like water eroding rock.
  10. **Make important relationships work, no matter what** (Gary Loveman and the CFO).
  11. **Make the vision compelling**: link your goal to a socially valuable aim ("on the side of the angels", shareholders' interests).

Class 7: Tactics of Influence: Three Ways to Project Influence (HBS Press)

Three practical ways to turn power into influence:

1. **Framing:** a frame is the mental window through which we view a problem ("if you're a hammer, everything looks like a nail"). "Establishing the framework… is often tantamount to determining the result" (Pfeffer).
   - Example: a junior manager, David, reframed a debate about one project's NPV into one about entering a new, high-margin market (the Normandy beachhead analogy). He did this with **personal power**, not position.
2. **Information:** compelling, irrefutable facts can break an impasse.
   - Example: the town golf course vs forest debate. A citizen showed the course only broke even because half its costs were hidden, and support for expansion melted away.

    - Watch for selective use of information. A reputation for **objectivity and truthfulness** builds personal power.
3. **Technical authority:** in a complex world, generalist decision-makers depend on experts, which gives specialists substantial influence.
    - Example: George, an MBA, became indispensable to two IT founders.

Tip: watch and learn from the most effective and ethical influencers around you.

Class 8: Difficult Conversations and Team Disagreement

Mastering Difficult Conversations (Stone & Hering, Rotman). Difficult conversations involve high stakes, risk to the relationship and identity questions. Every one contains **3 conversations**:

Conversation	Difficult-conversation stance	Learning-conversation stance
What happened? (truth, intentions, blame)	Whose story is right? They meant to hurt me. It's their fault.	Why do we see it differently? I don't like the impact; what did they intend? We each **contributed**.
Feelings	My feelings are their fault; vent or stay silent.	Share feelings without blame; acknowledge theirs with empathy.
Identity (what this says about me)	They're attacking my identity unfairly.	Part of what they say may make sense; their story can be valid without negating me.

- **Deciding whether to raise an issue:** people over-weight the short-term cost and ignore the long-term cost of letting it fester.
- **Separate intention from impact:** speak about the impact and be curious about their intent.
- **Learning conversation, not message delivery:** a two-way exchange to understand each other's views and work out a way forward.
- **5-step checklist:**
    1. Prepare by walking through the 3 conversations.
    2. Check your purpose and decide whether to raise it.
    3. **Start from the "third story"**: describe the difference between your two views in neutral terms, as an observer would.

4. Explore their story and yours: listen, paraphrase, and reframe (truth → perceptions, blame → contribution, accusations → feelings).
5. Problem-solve: options that meet both sides' concerns, standards, and a norm of mutual caretaking.

- **Emotions:** name and acknowledge them; don't suppress them.
- **Self-awareness:** if you get the same feedback 2–3 times, it is probably a blind spot.

How to Handle a Disagreement on Your Team (Brett & Goldberg, HBR 2017). A boss should act as a **mediator, not an authority**, so the parties own the solution and learn to resolve conflict themselves.

- **Separate or joint first?** Separate meetings let people vent and reassure anyone intimidated. Joint meetings allow controlled venting and build ownership. Research says **start separately and build empathy, then move to joint**.
- **Empathy, not sympathy:** "That must have been hard" is respectful and neutral. "I feel sorry" can sound like taking sides.
- **First meeting:** explain your role, set ground rules (respect, no interrupting), and calm emotions.
- **Draw out positions, interests and priorities** with why / why-not questions and by reformulating what you hear.
- **Pitfalls: facts, rights and power arguments.**
  - Facts: agree to disagree.
  - Rights or fairness: park it and look for information.
  - Power (threats): restate the ground rules.
- **Agreements:** a future-focused agreement on how to interact. If trust is low, make it **limited-duration**, **contingent** or **non-precedent-setting**.
- **If there is no agreement:** discuss the consequences of not agreeing; as a last resort, impose a decision and explain why.

Class 9: The New Science of Team Chemistry (Vickberg & Christfort, HBR 2017)

Teams underperform because leaders don't manage **differences in work style**. Deloitte's **Business Chemistry** model, built with Helen Fisher, has 4 styles. Most people lean towards 1–2 of them.

Style	Values	Typical traits	Energised by	Alienated by
Pioneer	Possibilities	Big picture, risk-taking, goes with the gut, imaginative	Brainstorming, spontaneity, enthusiasm	Rules and structure, detailed plans, process focus
Guardian	Stability	Order, rigour, data and detail, risk-averse, learns from the past	Organisation, predictability	Disorder, ambiguity, time pressure
Driver	Challenge	Results, winning, logical, black-and-white, direct	Solving problems, directness, winning	Indecision, inefficiency, lack of focus
Integrator	Connection	Relationships, diplomatic, consensus-seeking, empathic	Collaboration, trust and respect	Conflict, politics, inflexibility

- **True opposites:** Pioneer ↔ Guardian and Driver ↔ Integrator. 40% of people said their opposites were the hardest to work with.
- **3 ways to manage the styles:**
  1. **Pull your opposites closer**: pair them on small projects to create "productive friction" (Jobs and Wozniak, Lennon and McCartney).
  2. **Elevate the "tokens"** (the minority styles) to avoid **cascades**: once a discussion starts flowing one way, momentum keeps it going.
     - **Reputational cascade**: people fear looking bad if they disagree.
     - **Informational cascade**: people assume early speakers know more.
     - Tactics: let the minority speak early (Asch: one dissenter makes others more willing to dissent), have people brainstorm individually and then share round-robin, and ask people to "think like a Guardian".
  3. **Pay attention to sensitive introverts** (Guardians and "Quiet Integrators"). They report the most stress, are thorough and good at spotting risk. Give them prep time and solo work, ask them with a light touch, and reduce their stress.
- **Leadership profile:** most top leaders are Pioneers (about 36%) or Drivers, so executive teams are prone to cascades and groupthink.
- **Helen Fisher's brain basis for the styles:** dopamine (curious, risk-taking), serotonin (traditional, belonging), testosterone (direct, decisive), estrogen/oxytocin (empathetic, contextual thinking).

- **Executive uses:** staffing teams for balance, managing up (talk to a Driver boss in milestones), job crafting, and flexing into other styles when deciding ("touch all four quadrants").

Class 10: Managing Multicultural Teams (Brett, Behfar & Kern, HBR 2006)

The wrong managerial intervention makes teams dependent on the boss. In the opening case, a US–India team ended up leaning on the manager for every detail. The goal is to fix the problem **and** equip the team to handle it themselves next time.

4 cultural barriers

1. **Direct vs indirect communication:** in direct cultures the meaning is on the surface; in indirect ones it is embedded in context. A Westerner struggles to read indirect messages. Example: a US manager's direct email about flaws embarrassed her Japanese colleagues, who then isolated her (literally, in a storage room).
2. **Accents and fluency:** non-fluent members get seen as less competent, so the team doesn't use their expertise.
3. **Attitudes to hierarchy and authority:** people from hierarchical cultures defer or phrase things humbly and lose credibility on flat teams. Going over someone's head can cost face (the Korean due-diligence case).
4. **Decision-making norms:** speed and the amount of analysis differ. Americans decide fast; Koreans revisited points already agreed. Fix: small concessions on process, and be explicit about what you need.

4 strategies, chosen to fit the "enabling situational conditions":

Strategy	What it is	When to use it
Adaptation (best)	Acknowledge the cultural gaps openly and work around them, e.g. **fusion** of styles	Members can attribute the problem to culture, not personality
Structural intervention	Reorganise: mixed subgroups, an outside facilitator, reassigning tasks	Obvious subgroups, status inhibitions, negative stereotypes
Managerial intervention	Set norms early, or bring in a higher-level manager	A new team needs norms; loss of face; stalemate
Exit (last resort)	A member leaves, voluntarily or not	Emotions too high; too much face lost

- **Risks:** subgroups can harden existing divides, so someone has to mediate and fit the pieces back together. Managerial intervention can sideline members or make the team dependent.

Class 11: Virtual and Hybrid Teams (three readings)

Developing Team Trust: Leader Insights for Virtual Settings (Dinh, Salas et al., 2021). Trust is a dynamic, shared, **subjective** state that emerges in a team. Virtual work cuts both the *quantity* of contact (no water-cooler chats) and its *quality* (no non-verbal cues, tech glitches). There are two types of trust and 8 leader practices:

Trust type	Basis	Leader practices
Cognitive	Reliability, competence, predictability; a "logical calculation" built over time	1. Outline shared goals, benefits and risks (a **shared mental model**) · 2. Set boundaries and team norms (tech norms, newcomer coffee chats, systematic feedback) · 3. Monitor engagement (team emotional intelligence; watch for **Zoom fatigue** and over-monitoring) · 4. Clear roles
Affective	Familiarity, co-identification, care; emotional	5. Build an inclusive community through psychological safety (frame wins as team wins) · 6. Foster commitment to the organisation (resources, **empowering leadership**) · 7. Connect outside work (virtual happy hours, personal milestones) · 8. Encourage collaboration and **backup behaviour**; plan redundancy ("second in command")

Getting Virtual Teams Right (Ferrazzi, HBR 2014). 82% of virtual teams fall short of their goals, yet well-managed dispersed teams can **outperform co-located ones**. There are 4 must-haves:

1. **Right team:**
    - People with communication skills, emotional intelligence, independence and resilience.

    - **Small size (fewer than 10)**: the worst teams had 13 or more members. Social loafing kicks in above 4–5 people. Hackman: a 5-person team needs 10 conversations for everyone to connect; a 13-person team needs 78.
    - Roles in tiers (Ancona's **X-teams**): core, operational, outer.
2. **Right leadership:** foster trust (backgrounds, video tours of workspaces, personal news at the start of calls), encourage open dialogue ("caring criticism", a designated candour advocate), and clarify goals and guidelines (response times, specific requests, no multitasking; use video).
3. **Right touchpoints:** meet face to face at kickoff (builds **swift trust**; give pairs a "small win"), at onboarding (mentors), and at milestones.
4. **Right technology:** integrated platforms covering conference calls, video, direct calls and texts, and discussion forums ("messy talk", "working out loud").

- **Virtual distance** (Lojeski & Reilly) has three parts: **physical** (geography, time zones), **operational** (team size, other commitments, tech skills) and **affinity** (culture, rank, existing relationships). Teams high on virtual distance showed trust down 83%, innovation down 93%, satisfaction down 80% and performance down 50%.

Making the Hybrid Workplace Fair (Mortensen & Haas, HBR 2021). Hybrid work creates **power differentials** from two sources:

- **Hybridity positioning: resource access** (in-office people get better tech, information and social support) and **visibility** (being seen by those in power, which depends on your location relative to the boss).
- **Hybridity competence:** being "ambidextrous" across both worlds, building relationships in person and virtually, claiming resources and showing you are trustworthy when less visible. This is separate from positioning.
- **What managers should do:**
    1. **Track and communicate** the team's hybridity configuration (it keeps changing).
    2. **Design** to redistribute access and visibility, and check that KPIs and evaluations are fair.
    3. **Educate** about bias and build psychological safety.
    4. **Monitor** key moments: performance reviews, team launches, onboarding.

Classes 12–13: A Note on Team Process (Farkas & Hill, HBS 2001)

Teams beat individuals on **complex tasks that need diverse skills or buy-in**. Effectiveness depends on context, effort, ability and **process**. The note covers **4 aspects of process**:

1. **Decision-making:** avoid the **"solution-minded" trap** of grabbing the first solution that opinion leaders back. Use 4 steps:

   a. Identify and explore the problem (symptoms vs the real problem).
   b. Generate solutions (brainstorming; **nominal group technique**: write ideas individually, share round-robin, then vote).
   c. Refine and critique, aiming for **consensus** (an option everyone can live with). Avoid conflict avoidance at this stage.
   d. Actively manage implementation.
2. **Participation:** large imbalances are a warning sign. The most frequently stated ideas tend to be adopted regardless of quality (**valence effect**, Maier). Linguistic style affects who gets heard (Tannen: on average, women wait longer to speak). Intervene by **gatekeeping**: "Tom, let me see if I understand…", "Jamal, what are your ideas?"
3. **Influence** (not the same as participation): it is dangerous when the loudest or highest-ranking people dominate rather than the experts. Watch who gets listened to, who gets interrupted and where people sit. Intervene by reinforcing ignored views and widening the discussion.
4. **Conflict:** encourage **task conflict**, minimise **affective conflict**, and guard against groupthink (Hume: "truth springs from arguments amongst friends").
   - Members' hidden questions: **"Am I accepted? Do I have value? Do I have influence?"**
   - Suppressed anger comes back as disguised retaliation.
   - Fixes: set behaviour norms early, ground discussion in data, generate several alternatives, share power, agree common goals, use a devil's advocate, bring in outsiders.

Team development

- **Getting started:** the first meetings set lasting norms.
  - **Size 5–10**.
  - The right technical, conceptual and interpersonal competencies, plus team-skills training.
  - Include key stakeholders.
  - Build commitment and inclusion; avoid in-groups and out-groups.
  - Cognitive diversity (e.g. MBTI types) helps outcomes but makes the process harder.
  - Self-managed teams with no recognised leader perform worse.
- **Getting to work:**
  - The **purpose** comes from above; the team sets its own **demanding performance goals**, which is key to becoming a team (Katzenbach & Smith).
  - Clear roles and **mutual accountability** reduce social loafing.

    - Shape team culture and norms on power, communication, legitimate topics and how conflict is handled.
- **Monitoring:**
    - Regular **process checks** (20–30 minutes every 3rd–4th meeting).
    - **Manage the midpoint**, the natural point to change norms (punctuated equilibrium).
    - Evaluate on **3 criteria (Hackman)**: **perform**, member **satisfaction**, and ability to **adapt and learn**.

Global and virtual teams

- Diversity helps creative tasks most, computational tasks a little, and coordinative tasks least (it may even harm them).
- **"Internationalists"** ease friction.
- Differences in demeanour lead to stereotyping and affective conflict.
- A few national subgroups form **faultlines**. Many nationalities tend to build a shared team identity instead.
- **Virtual:** trust is judged on **integrity, ability and benevolence**, so share bios early. Email is democratic and efficient, but low on context and conflicts escalate more easily.

Hallmarks of effective team process: clear performance goals, full use of talents and views, diversity with integration, mutual accountability, rigorous decision-making, conflict resolution processes, and self-examination for continuous learning.

Class 14: The Business Case for Commitment to Diversity (Slater, Weigand & Zwirlein, 2008)

Commitment to diversity is an **"invisible asset"** behind visible advantages like cost and brand. It shows up in 4 areas: **CEO commitment, human capital, corporate communications, and supplier diversity**.

- **Resource-based view (Barney):** a resource gives sustained advantage if it is **valuable, rare, hard to imitate and has no close substitute**. A diversity culture is **socially complex**, so it is hard to copy, and human capital is the least substitutable resource.
- **3 ways diversity creates advantage:**
    1. **Decision quality**, from the boardroom to the front line. Hamel: strategic innovation needs a diverse set of voices. Customer orientation improved performance only when top-team diversity was high.

2. **Connecting with customers**: growing minority buying power. P&G's "first moment of truth"; Pepsi required half of new hires to be women or minorities. Employees who resemble customers lower communication costs.
3. **Innovation**: innovation happens at intersections, and minority opinions stimulate divergent thinking (Nooyi, IDEO).

- **Costs:** higher communication costs, lower cohesion, more turnover, and token hires feeling exploited. That is why most studies find a **weak or no** link between diversity and performance at a single level.
- **The authors' view:** diversity should be part of **culture, not a "programme"**. Evidence: the DiversityInc Top 50 beat matched peers on median net profit margin (about 2.7% higher per year), ROA and ROE **in every year from 1998 to 2003**. Diversity pays only with **deep, not superficial, commitment**.
- **Lessons for building commitment:**
  1. Tie diversity to business strategy with a business case tailored to the firm.
  2. **Line management owns it, not HR**; the CEO must be visibly involved (IBM's Gerstner set up 8 task forces).
  3. Set targets and metrics.
  4. Treat human capital as a competitive advantage.
  5. Recruit early (Marriott's high-school internships).
  6. Train for team-building and group process.
  7. Reach out to multicultural markets.
  8. Build a diverse supplier base.
  9. **Emphasise fairness** to avoid majority backlash and stigma for minorities.
  10. **Prepare for conflict**: avoid it early in the creative process and encourage it in the middle stages.

Class 15: The Myth of the Top Management Team (Katzenbach, HBR 1997)

Even in the best companies, the so-called top team **seldom functions as a real team**. Calling the group a team doesn't make it one.

- **A real team** is a small number of people with **complementary skills**, committed to a **common purpose, performance goals and approach**, for which they hold themselves **mutually accountable**. Katzenbach calls this the "discipline of team basics".
- **3 myths:**

    1. Teamwork at the top leads to team performance. But teamwork (the "4 Cs": communication, cooperation, collaboration, compromise) is **not the same as team performance**.
    2. Top teams should spend more time building consensus. But executives lack time, many decisions are better made individually, and **real teams thrive on conflict**.
    3. The senior group should act as a team whenever it meets. But most top-level interactions are **not** team opportunities.
- **Why non-team behaviour prevails at the top (7 reasons):**
    1. A meaningful team purpose is hard to define.
    2. Tangible goals are hard to set.
    3. The right mix of skills is often missing (the **"all my direct reports" fallacy**: membership by position, not skill).
    4. Teams need a heavy time commitment.
    5. Executives trust individual accountability over mutual accountability.
    6. Non-teams fit the **power structure** (the "power alley").
    7. Single-leader groups are **fast and efficient**.

Executive leadership discipline	Team discipline
Individual accountability	Mutual accountability for collective results
Broad strategy, policy, objectives	Tightly focused, specific performance goals
Creates urgency on critical issues	Mobilises around a meaningful purpose (may not be urgent)
Decides alone, on personal judgment	Collective judgment through dialogue, conflict, real work
Assigns people by position	Assigns people by the skills the task needs
Efficiency through processes	Seldom the most efficient way

- **3 litmus tests for a real team:**
    1. **Collective work-products** of clear value that members couldn't achieve alone.
    2. **Shifting leadership roles**: whoever has the most relevant expertise leads at that moment.
    3. **Mutual accountability**: "we hold one another accountable", not "the boss holds us accountable".

- **When top teams make sense:** major unexpected events such as mergers, crises and refinancing (Citicorp, Browning-Ferris). These bring urgency, measurable imperatives, a need to integrate skills, and temporary leadership roles.
    - Example: Mobil's CEO Lucio Noto led a leadership-development team, acting as a member more often than as its leader. Its guiding message: **"development, not evaluation"**.
- **Takeaway:** wise leaders **combine both disciplines**. They tell team opportunities from non-team ones and apply each where it fits.